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2027 CYCLE

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CUET UG

General Aptitude Test

General Knowledge, Current Affairs & Static GK

Official Syllabus · GT Paper · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA official CUET(UG) 2026 syllabus — General Aptitude Test (501), the current 2027 baseline)	Skills the questions test
Everyday knowledge	Everyday knowledge	Recalling the practical, common-sense knowledge of the world around you.
Significant events	Significant national and international events	Tracking the year's major happenings — who, where, when, why it matters.
The classic trio	Books & authors, awards, important days	Pairing books with writers, awards with fields, and dates with days — fast.

EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each test paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. The General Aptitude Test section named in the official syllabus is **General Knowledge, Current Affairs and Static GK**: everyday knowledge, significant national and international events, and the classic trio — books and authors, awards, important days. GK questions are answer-in-seconds items: either the fact is yours, or a sound method of guessing wisely protects you.

The Three Zones of General Knowledge

GK looks like an ocean, but it settles into three zones, and each zone has its own way of being learned. **Static GK** is the part that never changes — the books, the awards, the days, the firsts. **Current affairs** is the moving part — the last year's significant events. And **everyday knowledge** is the living part — the practical sense of how the world works. A topper's preparation treats the three zones differently instead of lumping them into one giant, scary pile.

- **Static GK rewards tables.** Organise facts by category, revise on a cycle, and the same facts serve you year after year.
- **Current affairs rewards a system.** A 15-minute daily habit with a note grid beats a 15-hour cram before the exam — memory is built by repeated small exposures.
- **Everyday knowledge rewards curiosity.** Every "why does that happen?" you actually look up becomes a question you can answer in the hall.

- **The zones overlap on purpose.** "Chandrayaan-3 landed near the Moon's south pole" is a current event whose STATIC hooks (ISRO, the Moon, India's space firsts) live in your static tables.
- **One notebook rules all three zones:** the 5-field note grid — what, when, where/who, why it matters, static link.

REAL-WORLD ANALOGY

Think of GK preparation like **maintaining a garden**. Static GK is the permanent planting — the trees you set once and water on schedule (your tables). Current affairs is the seasonal bed — new plants every month, old ones pruned when they stop being news. Everyday knowledge is the wild part that grows if you simply keep looking at it with interest. No gardener does it all in one weekend; the garden rewards a **little care every day**.

Static GK Map 1 — Books, Authors and Awards

Two categories where the facts never rot: who wrote what, and which award honours what. The trick is not reading long lists — it is **attaching one hook to each fact**. A hook is a single memory string: Tagore — first Indian Nobel — **Gitanjali**. Kalam — missile man, President — **Wings of Fire**. One hook per fact, and the pair survives for years.

Book	Author	The hook to attach
Gitanjali	Rabindranath Tagore	Won Tagore the Nobel Prize in Literature (1913) — Asia's first Nobel
The Discovery of India	Jawaharlal Nehru	Written in prison; Nehru was India's first Prime Minister
Godan	Munshi Premchand	The classic Hindi novel of rural Indian life
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	Autobiography of the "Missile Man" who became President
Malgudi Days	R.K. Narayan	The imaginary small town of Malgudi — short stories
Train to Pakistan	Khushwant Singh	Fiction set in the Partition of 1947

Award	Field it honours	The hook to attach
Bharat Ratna	Any field — India's highest civilian honour	The PEAK of the civilian pyramid; first given 1954
Param Vir Chakra	Wartime military valour	India's highest MILITARY award — do not swap with Bharat Ratna

Award	Field it honours	The hook to attach
Nobel Prize	Six fields: physics, chemistry, medicine, literature, peace, economics	The world's most famous award; economics added later (1969)
Jnanpith Award	Literature (Indian languages)	India's highest literary honour
Dadasaheb Phalke Award	Cinema	Named after the father of Indian cinema
Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna	Sports	Renamed from Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna — a favourite swap-trap fact

- **The pyramid habit:** for every award family, learn the TOP first (highest honour), then one rung below. Traps feed on pyramid swaps.
- **The currency rule:** award names and winners change. Whatever your sources said last year, re-verify the current holders close to exam day.

Static GK Map 2 — Important Days and Famous Firsts

Days and firsts are pure recall — so the memory method matters more than the material. Learn days **in month order** in small clusters of five, never as a shuffled list. Learn firsts as **chains**: first President → first woman President → first President born in the 21st-century era of officeholders you verify near exam time.

Date	Day	The hook to attach
26 January	Republic Day	The Constitution came into force in 1950
15 August	Independence Day	1947 — the date itself is static history
5 September	Teachers' Day	Birth anniversary of Dr S. Radhakrishnan
14 November	Children's Day	Birth anniversary of Jawaharlal Nehru
28 February	National Science Day	Marks the Raman Effect discovery (1928)
29 August	National Sports Day	Birth anniversary of hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand
8 March	International Women's Day	A global day — not an Indian-specific one
22 April	International Earth Day	Do not swap with Environment Day next line
5 June	World Environment Day	Run by the UN — environment month anchor
1 December	World AIDS Day	The classic December awareness day

Famous first	The answer	The hook to attach
First President of India	Dr Rajendra Prasad	Only President elected twice (1952, 1957)
First Prime Minister of India	Jawaharlal Nehru	Discovery of India — the same name from your books table
First Indian Nobel laureate	Rabindranath Tagore	Gitanjali — Literature, 1913
First woman President of India	Pratibha Patil	Office held 2007–2012
First Indian in space	Rakesh Sharma	1984 Soviet mission — "Saare Jahaan Se Achha"

Static GK Map 3 — Geography and Polity Anchors

A compact set of evergreen anchors covers a surprising share of everyday-Knowledge questions. These do not change from cycle to cycle — learn them once, revise monthly, own them for life. Where a fact has a common swap-trap (largest vs longest, world vs India), the hook says so.

Question shape	The anchor fact	The hook / trap to attach
Longest river in India	The Ganga	"Longest" (in India) — not largest by any other measure
Highest mountain in the world	Mount Everest	World — highest peak IN India is Kanchenjunga
Largest state of India by area	Rajasthan	Largest by area; population is a different question — verify current figures
Smallest state of India by area	Goa	Area, not population
Head of the Indian State	The President	Head of STATE vs head of GOVERNMENT — the classic swap
Head of the Indian Government	The Prime Minister	Runs the government day to day
India's legislature	Parliament = Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha + President	Two Houses plus the President completes it
Fundamental Rights	Guaranteed by the Constitution	Six rights — learn the count, verify details in your polity notes

Current Affairs: The System That Never Drowns You

Students fail current affairs not because it is hard, but because they prepare it **randomly** — a news video here, a magazine there, nothing written down. The fix is a small, boring, powerful system. Fifteen minutes a day, one note grid per event, one consolidation page a month. That is the whole machine — and it converts daily noise into exam-ready facts without taking over your life.

- **The daily diet (15 minutes):** scan headlines of one serious source; pick ONE significant story; read it fully; fill a note grid for it.
- **The monthly consolidation (45 minutes):** at month's end, copy all grids into one revision page per category — the six categories below.
- **The six categories to track:** national events · international events · sports · awards and honours · science and technology · appointments and offices.
- **The currency discipline:** offices and award holders change — in your last revision week, re-verify every "who holds it now" fact from a current source.
- **The pairing habit:** every current event gets a static link (which ministry, which city, which earlier "first" it joins) — this is what makes facts stick and doubles the value of every grid.

ONE EVENT THROUGH THE 5-FIELD GRID

Event: India's Chandrayaan-3 soft-lands near the Moon's south polar region.

- **WHAT:** soft landing of a lander-rover mission near the lunar south pole.
- **WHEN:** 23 August 2023 — now celebrated as National Space Day.
- **WHERE / WHO:** executed by ISRO; made India the first country to land in that polar region.
- **WHY IT MATTERS:** a historic first for exploration of that region; a national technology milestone.
- **STATIC LINK:** joins India's space firsts — Aryabhata (first Indian satellite), Rakesh Sharma (first Indian in space, 1984), Kalpana Chawla (first woman of Indian origin in space).

How GK Questions Are Framed — and the Answer Ritual

GK questions come in a handful of shapes. Knowing the shape tells you the safest way to answer. And because this paper carries −1 for wrong answers, the GK ritual is not "attempt everything wildly" — it is **graded confidence**: answer what you truly know, use structured elimination on the edges, and leave a total blank only for facts that are genuinely foreign to you.

Question shape	What it looks like	The answer ritual
Direct fact	"Who wrote Godan?"	Instant recall — answer and move on in under 10 seconds
Match the following	Four books, four authors; pair them	Anchor the sure pairs first, strike, then leftovers

Question shape	What it looks like	The answer ritual
"Which is NOT…"	Three true statements, one false	Verify each against your table; the odd one is the answer
Statement pairs	"Statement I / Statement II — both true?"	Judge each statement independently before combining
Current-applied	"The recent mission landed near which lunar region?"	Recall the grid: event → place/who chain

- **Graded confidence in practice:** full knowledge → answer instantly; partial knowledge → eliminate impossible options first, then choose; total blank → leave it, protect your score, move on.
- **The 10-second rule for GK:** if no recall arrives in ten seconds, switch to elimination — GK rarely rewards staring.

Your 8-Week GK Engine

One fixed plan removes the daily "what should I study?" debate. Eight weeks, six days a week, about 25 minutes a day. Weeks alternate between building static tables and grinding current-affairs grids, and every week closes with a 15-minute self-quiz. Simple, repeatable, done.

Week	Build (new material)	Revise (old material)
Week 1	Books–authors table + awards table	— (first week)
Week 2	Important days + famous firsts tables	Week 1 tables (15-min scan)
Week 3	Geography + polity anchors	Weeks 1–2 tables + start daily news grids
Week 4	Daily grids only; build month-1 consolidation page	All static tables, weekly quiz
Weeks 5–6	Daily grids continue; fill category gaps you miss most	Alternate static halves on odd/even days
Weeks 7–8	Daily grids continue; month-2 consolidation page	Full revision: all tables + both consolidation pages; final currency check

Key Facts and Rules: One-Stop Revision

GK, CURRENT AFFAIRS & STATIC GK — EVERY RULE ON ONE PAGE

Rule	Statement	Exam use
Three zones	Static GK, current affairs, everyday knowledge — each has its own method	Planning your prep
5-field grid	What, when, where/who, why it matters, static link — one grid per event	Current affairs daily diet
One hook per fact	Each book/award/day gets one memory string	All static recall
Award pyramid	Learn the TOP honour first, then one rung below	Award-swap traps
Civilian vs military	Bharat Ratna = civilian peak; Param Vir Chakra = military peak	Classic swap trap
Days in month order	Learn days as month-clustered fives, never shuffled	Day-date questions
Sports day anchor	29 Aug — Major Dhyan Chand's birth anniversary	Renamed-Khel-Ratna link
State vs Government	President = head of State; PM = head of Government	Polity swap traps
World vs India peaks	Everest = world; Kanchenjunga = India's highest	Geography traps
Graded confidence	Know → answer; partial → eliminate; blank → leave	The −1 marking defence
10-second rule	No recall in 10 seconds → switch to elimination	Time discipline
Currency check	Re-verify holders and award names near exam day	Current-affairs accuracy

The Currency Check — Your Last-Mile Verification

Static facts from your tables are safe forever, but a small set of facts has a shelf life: officeholders, award winners, and anything named after a living tradition. These are exactly the facts exam papers recycle year after year, so a short verification pass in your final revision week protects every current-affairs mark you prepared for.

- **Who holds it now?** Re-verify the President, Vice President, Prime Minister, and the governors or chief ministers you have noted in grids.

- **Who won it this year?** The current year's major award winners — literature, peace, cinema, sports — from one consolidated list.
- **What is it called now?** Award and scheme names change; the Khel Ratna renaming is the standing example of why names need a currency check.
- **What happened in the last quarter?** Skim your most recent note grids first — recent events fade fastest and are asked most.
- **One source, one hour.** Do this check from a single reliable current source in one sitting — scattered checks miss things.

Common Errors and Special Cases

THE TRAPS THIS TOPIC SETS — READ BEFORE THE MOCK

The habit you assume	The twist	The trap in the question
"I read the news, so I'm covered"	Unrecorded reading evaporates within days	Current-affairs recall
"Awards never change names"	The Khel Ratna was renamed for Major Dhyan Chand	Award-identity traps
"Bharat Ratna is the top award, full stop"	It is the top CIVILIAN award — the military peak is different	Award-pyramid swaps
"Teachers' Day and Children's Day are both November"	Teachers' Day is 5 September; Children's is 14 November	Day-date slips
"Everest must be India's highest too"	Everest is the world's; India's highest is Kanchenjunga	Geography swaps
"President and PM are interchangeable heads"	State vs Government — two distinct roles	Polity traps
"Last year's notes are fine"	Officeholders and winners change — currency matters	Stale-fact traps
"GK is crammed best in the final week"	GK compounds with daily exposure — grids beat cramming	Preparation planning

The 60-Second Self-Test

Cover the answers, say each one aloud, then check. If any answer takes longer than ten seconds, revisit that section.

- **Name the three zones of GK.** → Static GK, current affairs, everyday knowledge.
- **What are the five fields of the note grid?** → What, when, where/who, why it matters, static link.
- **India's highest civilian award, and India's highest military award?** → Bharat Ratna; Param Vir Chakra.
- **Which sports award was renamed for Major Dhyan Chand?** → The Khel Ratna (now Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna).
- **President and Prime Minister — who is head of State, who of Government?** → President: State; PM: Government.
- **You half-remember a fact with two options left. What now?** → Eliminate the impossible, choose from the rest — graded confidence.

The Whole Chapter in One Picture

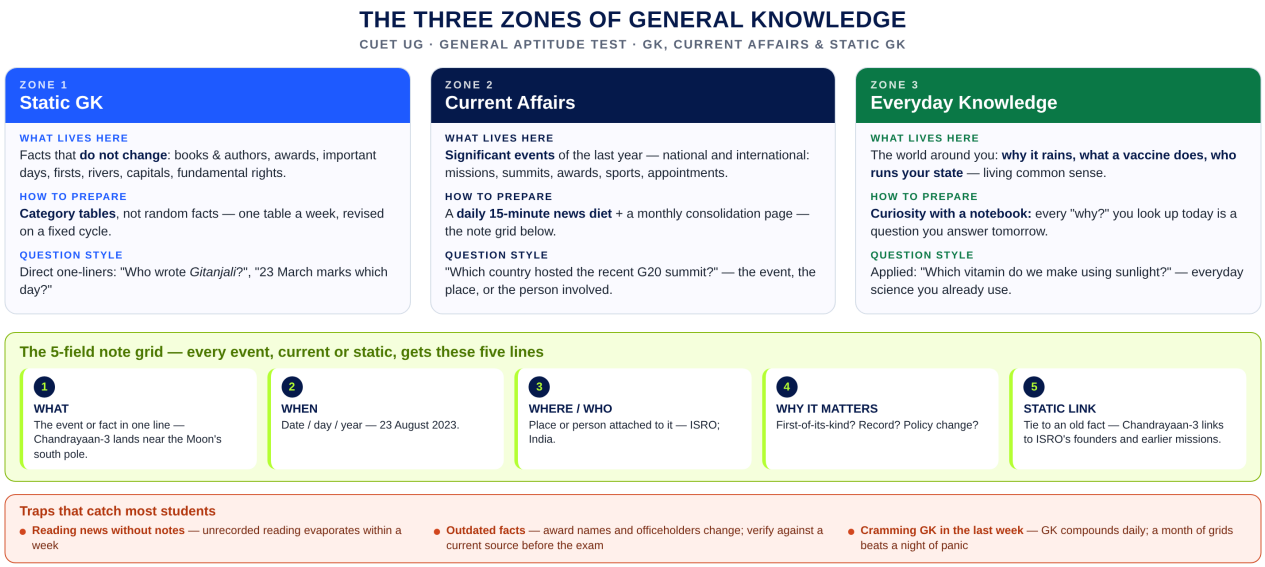


Figure 1: The three zones of General Knowledge — static GK, current affairs, everyday knowledge — each with its own preparation style, joined by the 5-field note grid that converts reading into marks.



Figure 2: Chapter mindmap: books and authors, the award pyramid, important days, the current-affairs system, geography-polity anchors, and the traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Ten questions in the CUET UG style — a mix of static recall, pairing, and NOT-statements, exactly the shapes this chapter rehearsed. Each correct answer earns +5; each incorrect one costs −1, so apply graded confidence.

Q1. The book “Gitanjali”, which brought the Nobel Prize in Literature to India in 1913, was written by:

(A) Munshi Premchand
(B) Rabindranath Tagore
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) R.K. Narayan

Q2. “Wings of Fire” is the autobiography of:

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Jawaharlal Nehru
(C) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam
(D) Khushwant Singh

Q3. Which of the following pairs is INCORRECTLY matched?

(A) Jnanpith Award — Literature
(B) Dadasaheb Phalke Award — Cinema
(C) Param Vir Chakra — Wartime military valour
(D) Bharat Ratna — Sports

Q4. India's National Sports Day, marking the birth anniversary of hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand, falls on:

(A) 29 August
(B) 5 September
(C) 22 April
(D) 28 February

Q5. National Science Day marks the discovery of the Raman Effect on 28 February. In which year did C.V. Raman make this discovery?

(A) 1913
(B) 1928
(C) 1947
(D) 1950

Q6. Which of the following is the highest PEAK located in India?

(A) Mount Everest
(B) K2
(C) Kanchenjunga
(D) Nanda Devi

Q7. In India's constitutional structure, the head of the GOVERNMENT (as distinct from the head of the State) is:

(A) the President
(B) the Prime Minister
(C) the Chief Justice
(D) the Vice President

Q8. Who was the first woman President of India?

(A) Indira Gandhi
(B) Pratibha Patil
(C) Sarojini Naidu
(D) Droupadi Murmu

Q9. Chandrayaan-3 made India the first country to soft-land near which region of the Moon?

(A) the north pole
(B) the south polar region
(C) the far side centre
(D) the Sea of Tranquility

Q10. Which of the following statements about India's Republic Day is TRUE?

(A) It marks the Constitution coming into force on 26 January 1950
(B) It marks independence from colonial rule in 1947
(C) It is celebrated on 15 August every year
(D) It commemorates the first general elections

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Detailed Solutions

Each solution shows the working, not just the verdict — cover the answer line, attempt the reasoning, then compare.

Sol. Q1. Static pair from the books table: Gitanjali — Tagore — 1913 Nobel in Literature, Asia's first. Premchand belongs to Godan; Nehru to The Discovery of India.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. Wings of Fire is Kalam's autobiography — the Missile Man who became President. Gandhi's is My Experiments with Truth; Nehru's is Discovery of India.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q3. The pyramid check: Bharat Ratna honours ANY field as India's highest CIVILIAN award — it is not a sports award. The other three pairs sit correctly in their fields.

Answer: (D)

Sol. Q4. 29 August — Major Dhyan Chand's birth anniversary. The distractors are all real days from your table: Teachers' (5 Sept), Earth (22 Apr), Science (28 Feb).

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q5. National Science Day (28 February) marks the Raman Effect discovered in 1928 — the work that later brought India's first science Nobel (1930). 1947 and 1950 belong to independence and the Constitution.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q6. The world-vs-India trap: Everest is the world's highest but lies in Nepal. Kanchenjunga — on India's border with Nepal — is the highest peak located in India.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q7. The two-heads rule: President = head of the STATE; Prime Minister = head of the GOVERNMENT, running it day to day. The judiciary interprets; it does not head the government.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q8. Pratibha Patil held the office from 2007 to 2012 — the first woman President. Indira Gandhi was Prime Minister, not President; Naidu was the first woman Governor of a state and later President of the Congress; the current officeholder should always be re-verified near exam day.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q9. The grid chain: Chandrayaan-3 (23 August 2023, ISRO) soft-landed near the lunar SOUTH POLAR region — a first for any country. The north pole and other sites belong to earlier missions of other nations.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q10. Republic Day = 26 January 1950, the day the Constitution came into force. Option B describes Independence Day (15 August) — the classic day-date swap.

Answer: (A)

Wrong-Answer Clinic — the one-line corrections

Dropped marks above? Find your slip here and rewrite the corrected rule in your own words.

If you answered...	Your slip was...	The corrected rule, in one line
Q2 option A	Stacking autobiographies in one pile	Wings of Fire = Kalam; My Experiments with Truth = Gandhi
Q3 option A/B/C	Doubting correct pairs	Verify all four pairs — the wrong one is Bharat Ratna, the civilian peak
Q4 option B	Mixing September days	5 Sept = Teachers'; 29 Aug = Sports (Dhyan Chand)
Q6 option A	Letting "world's highest" leak into India's	Everest = world; Kanchenjunga = India's highest
Q7 option A	Merging the two heads	President = State; PM = Government — never interchangeable
Q10 option B	Swapping Republic for Independence	26 Jan 1950 = Constitution in force; 15 Aug 1947 = independence

Your GK Habit Card

Everything this chapter taught, shrunk to one card you can pin above your desk. The card works because it asks nothing heroic: fifteen minutes on ordinary days, one consolidation sitting a month, one verification hour before the exam. Run it exactly as written for eight weeks and GK stops being a subject you fear and becomes a section you finish early.

Rhythm	The ritual	What it produces
Daily · 15 min	Headlines + one deep story + one note grid	Six category pages of current facts, growing quietly
Weekly · 15 min	Scan all static tables made so far	Tables stay warm — no re-learning ever needed
Monthly · 45 min	Consolidate grids into one revision page per category	A shrinking stack of pages instead of a pile of loose notes
Pre-exam · 1 hour	The currency check from one reliable source	No stale officeholders, no renamed-award slips

- **The rule that makes the card work:** never read a significant event without filling its grid — reading without noting is entertainment, not preparation.
- **The rule that protects your score:** graded confidence — full recall answers, partial recall eliminates, blank facts walk away.

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